type of structure for the execution of various activities needed for the projects. In less than four months, four hundred scientists began to work on the missile programme.

During this period, the most important task before me was the selection of the Project Directors to lead individual missile projects. We had a very large pool of talent. In fact, it was a market of plenty. The question was whom to pick—a go-getter, a planner, a maverick, a dictator or a team man? I had to get the right type of leader who could clearly visualize the goal, and channelise the energies of his team members who would be working at different work centres in pursuit of their own individual goals.

It was a difficult game, some rules of which I had learnt while working on ISRO's high priority projects for two decades. The wrong choice would jeopardise the entire future of the programme. I had a detailed discussion with a large number of prospective scientists and engineers. I wanted these five Project Directors to train another twenty-five project directors and team leaders of tomorrow.

Many of my senior col eagues—naming them would be unfair, because it could be only my imagination—tried to